

SLR-E01 – Intended Post-Feedback Deadline Rule

Status: Proposed – awaiting stakeholder approval

Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to define what happens to a task deadline after a student receives feedback.

Proposed Policy

When a student receives an eligible feedback outcome, the task deadline will be extended to seven calendar days after the feedback timestamp.

The seven days are calculated from the time when the feedback is recorded in OnTrack. The new deadline is not calculated by adding seven days to the old task deadline.

Triggering Outcomes

The automatic seven-day extension applies to the following feedback outcomes:

- * Fix and Resubmit
- * Discuss
- * Rediscuss
- * Demonstrate

Other feedback outcomes do not automatically trigger the extension unless they are added to the approved policy later.

Deadline Calculation

The new deadline is:

Feedback timestamp + 7 calendar days

The new deadline replaces the current task deadline only when the feedback outcome is eligible for the automatic extension.

The calculation uses the OnTrack system time zone for the relevant task/unit. Daylight-saving changes are handled by the normal calendar date and time-zone rules. The system should not simply add a fixed number of hours.

Exceptions and Overrides

1. Approved extensions

If a student already has an approved extension, the automatic seven-day deadline must not remove or reduce the approved extension.

The resulting deadline should be the later applicable deadline.

2. Flexible dates

For tasks with flexible dates, the automatic extension can still apply after eligible feedback. The new date should be calculated from the feedback timestamp.

3. Final deadlines

A final deadline must not be extended beyond the final deadline unless an authorised stakeholder has explicitly approved an extension.

4. Maximum dates

If a task has a maximum allowed date, the automatic extension must not move the deadline beyond that maximum date.

5. Repeated feedback

Each new eligible feedback event is considered separately.

If another eligible feedback event is recorded before the current extended deadline, the deadline is recalculated as seven calendar days from the latest eligible feedback timestamp, subject to final and maximum deadlines.

6. Group submissions

The same deadline rule applies to group submissions. The extension applies to the relevant task/submission rather than creating separate deadlines for individual group members.

Task-Level Opt-Out

The automatic extension should be enabled by default for new and existing tasks.

Unit chairs or authorised staff should be able to disable the automatic extension for selected tasks.

If the feature is disabled for a task, eligible feedback on that task does not automatically change the deadline.

Existing and New Tasks

The default behaviour should apply to both existing and new tasks.

The task-level setting should determine whether the rule is active.

Changing the setting does not change historical deadlines automatically.

Historical Feedback

The policy applies only to future eligible feedback events after the feature is enabled.

Existing feedback records should not automatically create or change deadlines when the feature is introduced.

If an authorised staff member manually changes a deadline, that manual change remains effective.

User-Facing Wording

When an eligible feedback outcome is recorded, students should see a clear message explaining the new deadline.

Suggested wording:

"Your task deadline has been extended to [date and time] because you received feedback requiring further action."

If the task has a final or maximum deadline that prevents the full seven-day extension, the message should explain the actual deadline.

Worked Examples

Example 1 – Normal case

Original deadline: 20 September 2026, 5:00 PM

Feedback timestamp: 15 September 2026, 2:00 PM

Feedback outcome: Fix and Resubmit

New deadline: 22 September 2026, 2:00 PM

Reason: Seven calendar days are added to the feedback timestamp.

Example 2 – Feedback received after the original deadline

Original deadline: 15 September 2026, 5:00 PM

Feedback timestamp: 16 September 2026, 10:00 AM

Feedback outcome: Discuss

New deadline: 23 September 2026, 10:00 AM

Reason: The calculation is based on the feedback timestamp, not the old deadline.

Example 3 – Repeated feedback

First feedback: 10 September 2026, 9:00 AM

First new deadline: 17 September 2026, 9:00 AM

Second eligible feedback: 14 September 2026, 3:00 PM

New deadline: 21 September 2026, 3:00 PM

Reason: The latest eligible feedback event recalculates the deadline.

Example 4 – Existing approved extension

Original deadline: 20 September 2026

Approved extension deadline: 25 September 2026

Eligible feedback: 18 September 2026, 10:00 AM

Seven-day calculated deadline: 25 September 2026, 10:00 AM

Result: The later applicable deadline is used, subject to any final or maximum deadline.

Example 5 – Task-level opt-out

Task automatic extension: Disabled

Feedback timestamp: 18 September 2026, 10:00 AM

Feedback outcome: Fix and Resubmit

Result: The task deadline is not automatically changed.

Acceptance Test Requirements

The approved policy should be testable using the following cases:

- * An eligible feedback outcome creates a deadline seven calendar days after the feedback timestamp.
- * An ineligible feedback outcome does not change the deadline.
- * Feedback received after the original deadline still creates the seven-day deadline when the rule is enabled.
- * Repeated eligible feedback uses the latest eligible feedback timestamp.
- * An approved extension is not reduced by the automatic rule.
- * A final or maximum de